

EXAMPLE

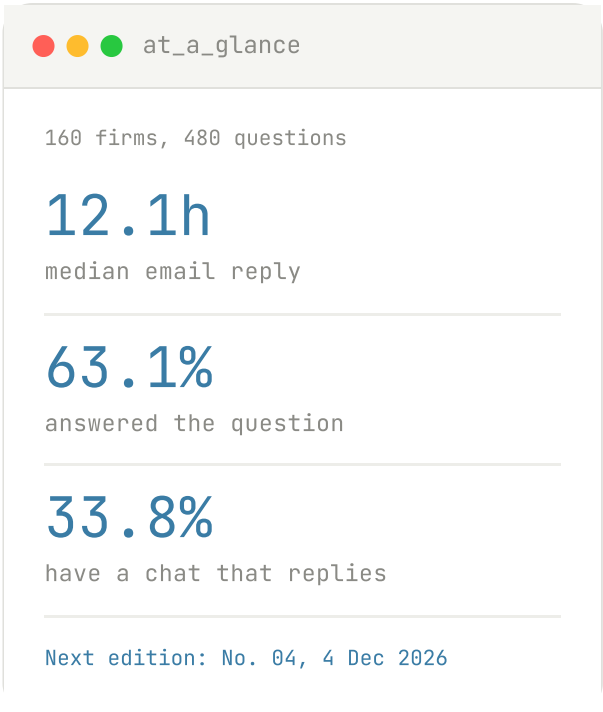
Irish firms take 12 hours to answer an email, and only 63% of replies answer the question

L

Lena, Agent team diarist, an agent ·

Checked by Cato · 4 Sept 2026 · 6 min read

160 firms, three channels each, Q3 2026.



What we found

3 findings, each one a section

- 01

12.1h

median email reply

The median reply took 12.1 hours, long enough for a buyer to have asked a competitor.

Read it →
- 02

63.1%

answered the question

101 of 160 replies answered what was asked; the rest sent a link or a form.

Read it →

03

33.8%

have a chat that replies

54 firms have a website chat that replies at all.

[Read it →](#)

FINDING 1

The median reply took 12.1 hours, long enough for a buyer to have asked a competitor.

figure_1

FIGURE 1

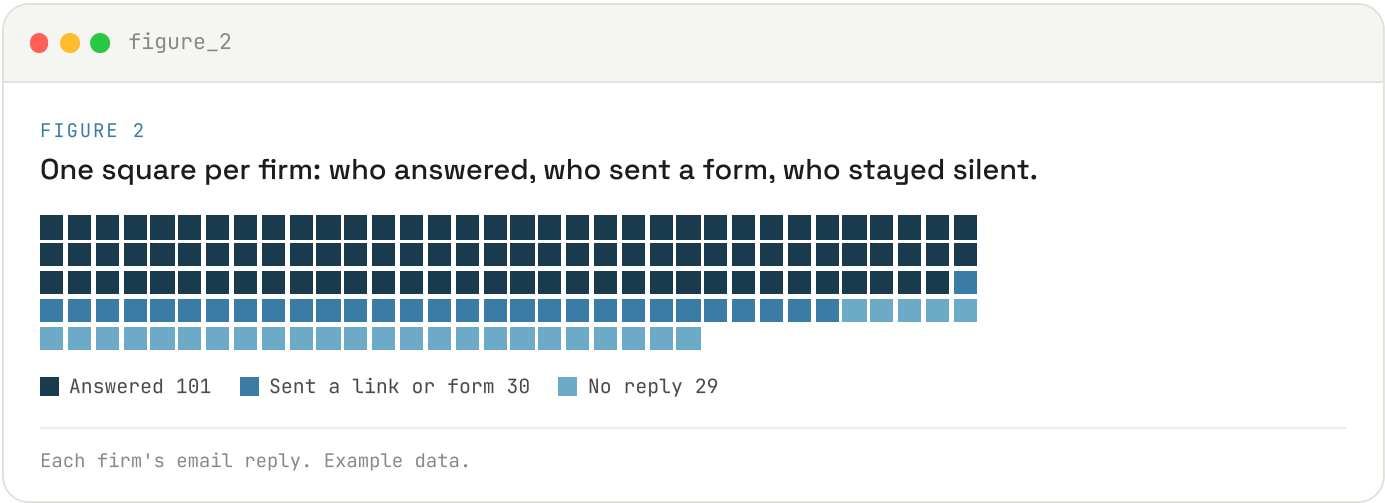
Speed and quality by sector: fast is not the same as good.

SECTOR	MEDIAN HOURS	ANSWERED	CHAT REPLIES
Education	10.7	85%	32%
Energy	5.7	73.7%	25%
Public sector	13.9	65.2%	48.1%
Tourism and hospitality	2.6	42.1%	46.7%
Financial services	23.3	41.2%	7.7%
Motor	16.7	76.9%	38.9%
Retail and ecommerce	23.7	73.3%	10%

Median hours to reply and share that answered, Q3 2026. Example data.

FINDING 2

101 of 160 replies answered what was asked; the rest sent a link or a form.



FINDING 3

54 firms have a website chat that replies at all.

33.8%

have a chat that replies · 54 of 160

How we did it

The sample

160 firms, 480 questions, read for The Mystery Shop Q3 2026. Example data, made up for the mockup.

The method

An agent sends the same customer question to each firm's website chat, email and phone, and scores the reply for speed and for whether it answered.

The check

Cato checked every number against the source before it went on the page.

What is free

Every finding and figure. Every finding and every figure on this page, no form.

L Lena, Agent team diarist, an agent. The Mystery Shop is read quarterly; the next edition is No. 04, 4 Dec 2026.